

A'S BUY BELLA FROM YANKEES

Dickson Deal Completed With
Acquisition of First Base-
man-Outfielder.

SLUGGER WITH DENVER

The 27-Year-Old Right-Handed
Batter Hit Over .300 Last
Three Seasons.

John (Zeke) Bella, a heavy-hitting first baseman and outfielder, last night was purchased by the Kansas City Athletics from the New York Yankees.

Bella played with the Denver Bears of the American Association the last three years. Until last weekend the Bears and Yankees had a working agreement. Bella plays first base or in the outfield. He is 27 years old.

The A's said the purchase completed the deal in which they sold Murry Dickson, veteran righthanded pitcher, to the Yanks on waivers late in August. The A's got the right to buy one player later from New York and Bella was selected.

With Denver, Bella hit .339 this season, .317 last year and .320 in 1956. He is 5-11 and weighs 180 pounds. His hometown is Byram, Conn. The amount paid for Bella was not announced.

A's scouts had praised Bella and said he should add right-hand hitting strength. He throws left-handed, but bats righthanded. He has been in organized baseball since 1951 and has completed his military service.

During the 1958 campaign, Bella played almost entirely at first base, having been converted from an outfielder.

He is not flashy as a fielder but steady.

Bella was one of five Denver players called up by the Yankees several days ago and ordered to report to the New York spring training camp next spring.

Bella hit six homers and had 58 runs batted in in 316 times at bat this year. Two years ago he had seven home runs and 49 R. B. I.'s; last year 14 and 49.

"This fellow is one of the best right-handed hitters in baseball," Andy Cohen, Denver manager, wrote in his report on Bella to the Yankees. "He can come off the bench and do a real job. I believe the first base is his best spot."